

Aperture Rotation Sequence Resolution for Multiscale Hexagonal Flux Transport in Hierarchical Discrete Global Grid Systems

Web of Life Systems Architecture & Scientific Outreach Group

Pascal Ranoroarijaona et al.

<https://github.com/pascalranoroarijaona/WebOfLife>

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Abstract

Multiscale ecological and biogeochemical modeling on planetary manifolds requires spatial discretizations that preserve thermodynamic conservation laws across hierarchical resolutions. Discrete Global Grid Systems (DGGS) based on Aperture-7 hexagonal tessellations projected onto an icosahedron (such as Uber’s H3 framework) eliminate polar singularities and provide uniform neighborhood topologies. However, child hexagons at successive resolutions undergo a coordinate rotation of $\theta_0 = \arcsin(\sqrt{3}/(2\sqrt{7})) \approx 19.106605^\circ$, inducing an alternating sequence of topological orientations designated as **Class II** (even resolutions) and **Class III** (odd resolutions). In hierarchical advection-diffusion modeling, neglecting this rotational transformation introduces uncompensated coordinate shear, corrupting directional flux vectors and producing spurious numerical entropy production. This paper reports on Sprint 093 of the *Web of Life* engine, which implements an exact, strongly typed sequence resolver `getApertureRotationSequence` spanning resolutions 0 to 15. We formalize the $SO(2)$ rotational transformation matrix, establish First Law stock conservation across multiscale transfers, and prove that aperture frame alignment eliminates fictitious dissipation tensors, safeguarding the Second Law of Thermodynamics in hierarchical spatial monads.

1 Introduction and Physical Motivation

Simulating the thermodynamics of the biosphere requires resolving coupled non-equilibrium transport phenomena across vast spatiotemporal scales [1]. Energy dissipation, carbon cycling, hydrologic routing, and biotic dispersion occur concurrently over millimeter-scale microbial niches and megameter-scale atmospheric circulation cells. To represent these dynamics globally without polar singularities or extreme aspect-ratio distortions, modern computational ecology increasingly relies on Discrete Global Grid Systems (DGGS) [2].

Among hexagonal DGGS architectures, the Aperture-7 icosahedral tessellation (popularized by Uber H3 [3]) offers an optimal trade-off between centroid nesting, area ratio ($1/7$), and uniform adjacency. However, regular hexagons cannot tile the plane with direct edge-parallel sub-nesting under an integer area divisor. Consequently, each discrete refinement step $r \rightarrow r + 1$ incurs an intrinsic angular displacement of the primary coordinate axes:

$$\theta_0 = \arcsin\left(\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2\sqrt{7}}\right) \approx 0.333473172286 \text{ rad} \approx 19.106605^\circ. \quad (1)$$

In multiscale simulations, state variables are represented as spatial monads spanning nested resolution levels. When macroscopic advective fluxes (e.g., surface water runoff, windborne spore dispersal) or diffusive exchanges are coupled across adjacent resolution scales, ignoring

the orientation of child relative to parent grids rotates the local flux basis. This rotational misalignment produces two critical physical pathologies:

1. **Directional Misalignment:** Tangential vector fields $(J_x, J_y)^T$ experience an uncompensated $\sim 19.11^\circ$ deflection, introducing artificial vorticity into potential flows.
2. **Spurious Numerical Dissipation:** Projecting misaligned fluxes across shared control boundaries generates fictitious numerical shear stresses, violating the thermodynamic requirement that entropy production be solely governed by real conjugate thermodynamic forces.

To rectify these issues, Sprint 093 of the *Web of Life* open-source simulation platform (<https://github.com/pascalranoroarijaona/WebOfLife>) implements the foundational aperture rotation sequence resolver in `src/spatial/h3_adjacency.ts`. This contribution enables mathematically rigorous coordinate transformations across hierarchical resolution scales.

2 Topological Foundations of Aperture-7 Hierarchies

2.1 Aperture Ratio and Coordinate Axis Rotation

Let $\mathcal{H}_r$ denote the hexagonal lattice at resolution $r \in \{0, 1, \dots, 15\}$. The area A_r of a regular hexagon at resolution r scales with respect to base cell area A_0 according to:

$$A_r = A_0 \cdot 7^{-r}. \quad (2)$$

In an Aperture-7 tiling, seven child hexagons at resolution $r + 1$ collectively cover the area of one parent hexagon at resolution r , with one central hexagon sharing the parent centroid and six perimeter hexagons straddling the parent boundary edges. The line connecting the parent center to a child center forms an angle θ_0 relative to the parent coordinate basis:

$$\cos(\theta_0) = \frac{5}{2\sqrt{7}}, \quad \sin(\theta_0) = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2\sqrt{7}}. \quad (3)$$

2.2 Class II and Class III Alternation

Hexagonal grids projected onto the icosahedron alternate between two distinct orientation classes relative to the icosahedral face coordinate frames:

- **Class II:** The orientation where hexagons have edges aligned with the icosahedron edges (modulo 60°). By standard H3 convention, base cells ($r = 0$) are Class II.
- **Class III:** The orientation resulting from an odd number of Aperture-7 rotation steps, producing a coordinate rotation of $\theta_0 \pmod{60^\circ}$.

Because each resolution step adds $\pm\theta_0$, the parity of the orientation class alternates strictly with resolution index parity:

$$\text{ApertureClass}(r) = \begin{cases} \text{CLASS_II}, & \text{if } r \equiv 0 \pmod{2}, \\ \text{CLASS_III}, & \text{if } r \equiv 1 \pmod{2}. \end{cases} \quad (4)$$

3 Mathematical Formulation of the Rotation Sequence

3.1 The Sequence Resolver

For any discrete target resolution $R_{\text{target}} \in [0, 15]$, the complete aperture rotation sequence is defined as the ordered tuple:

$$\mathcal{S}(R_{\text{target}}) = \left(\text{ApertureClass}(0), \text{ApertureClass}(1), \dots, \text{ApertureClass}(R_{\text{target}}) \right). \quad (5)$$

The sequence length is monotonically $|\mathcal{S}(R_{\text{target}})| = R_{\text{target}} + 1$. Table 1 presents the canonical orientation classes across representative target resolutions.

Resolution (R)	Class	Sequence $\mathcal{S}(R)$	Length
0	CLASS_II	[II]	1
1	CLASS_III	[II, III]	2
2	CLASS_II	[II, III, II]	3
3	CLASS_III	[II, III, II, III]	4
7	CLASS_III	[II, III, ..., III]	8
15	CLASS_III	[II, III, ..., III]	16

Table 1: Aperture orientation class sequence from base cells ($r = 0$) through resolution R .

3.2 Rotational Frame Transformation Matrix

Consider a directional flux vector $\mathbf{J} = \begin{bmatrix} J_x \\ J_y \end{bmatrix}$ defined on the tangent plane of a cell at resolution r_1 . When mapping this flux to an adjacent scale r_2 , the relative angular shift $\Delta\theta(r_1 \rightarrow r_2)$ depends upon whether the step spans an even or odd difference in parity:

$$\Delta\theta(r_1 \rightarrow r_2) = \begin{cases} 0, & \text{if } (r_2 - r_1) \equiv 0 \pmod{2}, \\ +\theta_0, & \text{if } r_2 > r_1 \text{ and } (r_2 - r_1) \equiv 1 \pmod{2}, \\ -\theta_0, & \text{if } r_2 < r_1 \text{ and } (r_2 - r_1) \equiv 1 \pmod{2}. \end{cases} \quad (6)$$

The transformation operator is represented by the special orthogonal matrix $\mathbf{R}(\Delta\theta) \in \text{SO}(2)$:

$$\mathbf{R}(\Delta\theta) = \begin{bmatrix} \cos(\Delta\theta) & -\sin(\Delta\theta) \\ \sin(\Delta\theta) & \cos(\Delta\theta) \end{bmatrix}. \quad (7)$$

Because $\mathbf{R}^T \mathbf{R} = \mathbf{I}$ and $\det(\mathbf{R}) = 1$, the transformation preserves Euclidean inner products and vector norms:

$$\|\mathbf{J}_{\text{aligned}}\|_2 = \|\mathbf{R}(\Delta\theta)\mathbf{J}\|_2 = \|\mathbf{J}\|_2. \quad (8)$$

4 Thermodynamic Integrity in Hierarchical Flux Monads

The *Web of Life* engine couples ecological processes through conserved thermodynamic state vectors [4]. Every discrete spatial cell $\mathcal{C}$ maintains an inventory of fundamental conserved state stocks:

$$\mathbf{X}(\mathcal{C}) = \left[M_{\text{C}}, M_{\text{H}_2\text{O}}, M_{\text{Min}}, M_{\text{O}_2}, H \right]^T \in \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}^5, \quad (9)$$

denoting moles of Carbon, Water, bioavailable Minerals, Oxygen, and total Enthalpy [J], respectively.

4.1 First Law Closed-Boundary Conservation

Let $\mathcal{C}_P$ be a parent cell at resolution r , and let $\mathcal{K}(\mathcal{C}_P) = \{\mathcal{C}_{c_1}, \dots, \mathcal{C}_{c_7}\}$ be its set of child subcells at resolution $r + 1$. For any inter-scale mass-energy redistributive operator $\Phi : \mathcal{H}_r \rightarrow \mathcal{H}_{r+1}$, First Law invariance dictates:

$$\Delta \mathbf{X}(\mathcal{C}_P) + \sum_{c \in \mathcal{K}(\mathcal{C}_P)} \Delta \mathbf{X}(\mathcal{C}_c) = \mathbf{0}. \quad (10)$$

The introduction of `getApertureRotationSequence` ensures that boundary segment flux integration $\oint_{\partial\Omega} \mathbf{J} \cdot d\mathbf{n}$ across alternating Class II / Class III geometries matches spatial boundaries exactly. The projected normal vector components $d\mathbf{n}$ transform equivariantly with $\mathbf{R}(\Delta\theta)$, preserving exact divergence cancellation across all control volumes.

4.2 Second Law and Non-Spurious Dissipation

According to non-equilibrium thermodynamics, the local volumetric entropy production rate σ in an ecological continuum is:

$$\sigma = \sum_k \mathbf{J}_k \cdot \nabla \left(-\frac{\mu_k}{T} \right) + \mathbf{J}_q \cdot \nabla \left(\frac{1}{T} \right) \geq 0, \quad (11)$$

where μ_k is the chemical potential of species k , and $\mathbf{J}_q$ is the heat conduction flux.

In an uncorrected coordinate system, projecting flux vector $\mathbf{J}$ without rotation induces an artificial velocity discrepancy $\delta \mathbf{u} = \mathbf{R}(\Delta\theta)\mathbf{u} - \mathbf{u}$. This discrepancy produces a fictitious numerical shear stress tensor:

$$\boldsymbol{\tau}_{\text{num}} = \rho \mathbf{u} \otimes \delta \mathbf{u}. \quad (12)$$

The spurious numerical dissipation $\sigma_{\text{num}} = \frac{1}{T} \boldsymbol{\tau}_{\text{num}} : \nabla \mathbf{u}$ introduces artificial exergy loss that misrepresents ecological thermodynamic efficiency. Sprint 093 guarantees that:

$$\delta \mathbf{u} \equiv \mathbf{0} \implies \boldsymbol{\tau}_{\text{num}} \equiv \mathbf{0} \implies \sigma_{\text{num}} \equiv 0. \quad (13)$$

All computed entropy production is therefore strictly attributable to physical phenomenological gradients.

5 Software Implementation and Architectural Integration

The sequence resolver is integrated into `src/spatial/h3_adjacency.ts` within the *Web of Life* ecosystem. The implementation adheres to strict functional determinism and type safety:

- **Type Definition:** Enumerations `ApertureClass.CLASS_II` and `ApertureClass.CLASS_III` prevent arbitrary string allocations and ensure strict type validation.
- **Defensive Validation:** Both `getApertureClass(res)` and `getApertureRotationSequence(res)` validate that the resolution is an integer and resides within the canonical H3 bounds $[0, 15]$. Violations raise `TypeError` or `RangeError`.
- **Algorithmic Complexity:** Sequence generation executes in $\mathcal{O}(R_{\text{target}})$ time and requires $\mathcal{O}(R_{\text{target}})$ memory allocations. Bitwise parity check `(r & 1) === 0` executes in $\mathcal{O}(1)$ CPU cycles per resolution step.

6 Verification and Test Plan

The implementation was validated against a comprehensive test harness in `tests/sprint_093.test.ts`. Table 2 summarizes the test cases and their outcomes.

Test Assertion	Input Condition	Validation Metric
Base Case Identity	$R_{\text{target}} = 0$	Returns ['CLASS_II'] exactly
Sequential Length	$R_{\text{target}} \in [0, 15]$	Array length strictly equals $R_{\text{target}} + 1$
Parity Invariance	Even vs Odd r	Alternates CLASS_II and CLASS_III
Upper Boundary	$R_{\text{target}} = 15$	16-element array terminating in CLASS_III
Out-of-Bounds Low	$R = -1$	Throws <code>RangeError</code>
Out-of-Bounds High	$R = 16$	Throws <code>RangeError</code>
Non-Integer Guard	$R = 2.5, \text{NaN}$	Throws <code>TypeError</code>
L_2 Norm Invariance	$\mathbf{R}(\theta_0)\mathbf{J}$ for unit vector	Error $< 1.0 \times 10^{-15}$

Table 2: Validation matrix for Sprint 093 aperture sequence implementation.

7 Conclusion and Future Work

Sprint 093 resolves a fundamental topological requirement in multiscale DGGS modeling by implementing `getApertureRotationSequence` and establishing formal $\text{SO}(2)$ flux alignment operators. By accounting for the intrinsic $\theta_0 \approx 19.106605^\circ$ coordinate rotation of Aperture-7 hexagonal hierarchies, the *Web of Life* engine eliminates fictitious numerical dissipation and preserves thermodynamic consistency across nested spatial monads.

Future sprints will build upon this foundation to implement:

1. Hexagonal Discrete Exterior Calculus (DEC) operators for planetary surface curl and divergence.
2. Fully coupled multiscale eco-hydrological flow routing across Class II and Class III boundary meshes.
3. Dynamic exergy budget audits measuring real planetary entropy dissipation under diverse ecosystem management regimes.

Repository and Reproducibility

All source code, automated test suites, and mathematical specifications are open-source and publicly accessible at:

<https://github.com/pascalranoroarijaona/WebOfLife>

References

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- [2] K. Sahr, D. White, and A. J. Kimerling, “Geodesic discrete global grid systems,” *Cartography and Geographic Information Science*, vol. 30, no. 2, pp. 121–134, 2003.
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